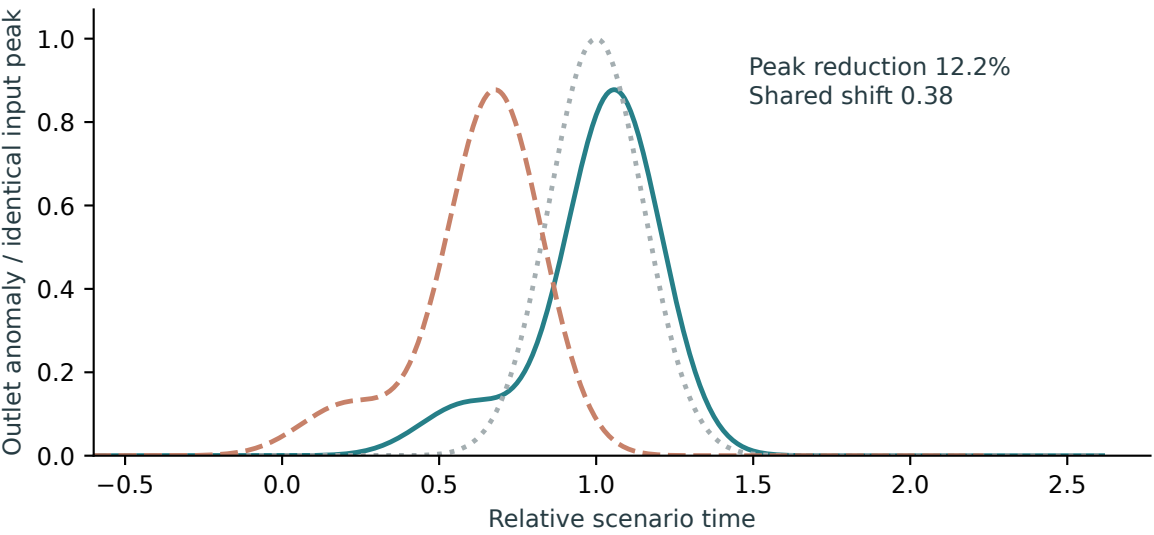


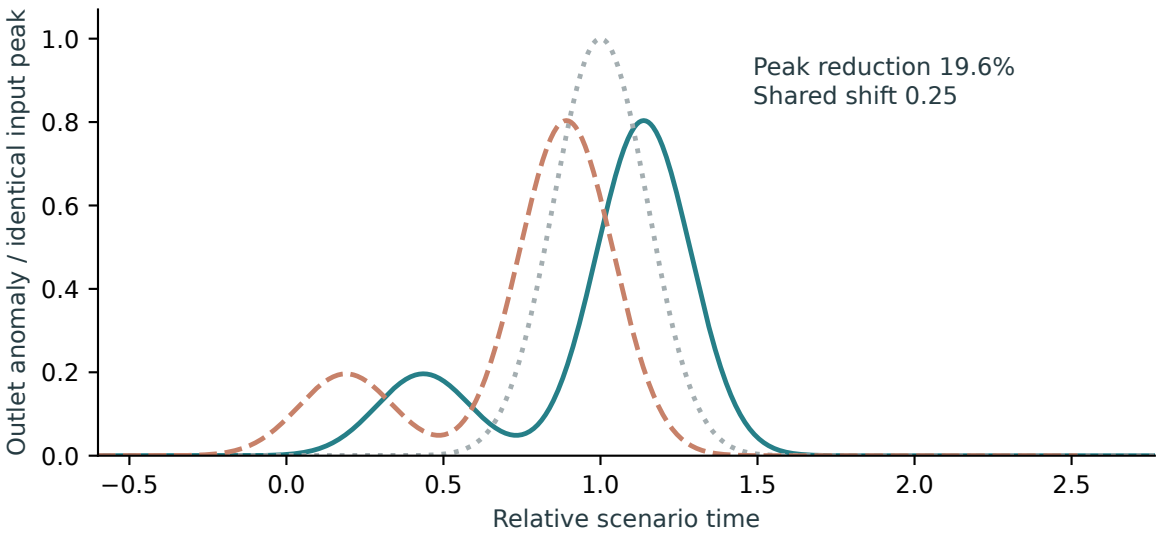
Branch differences disperse peaks; the common trunk shifts both signals

Actual branches + trunk Equal branches + same trunk Same branches, no shared trunk

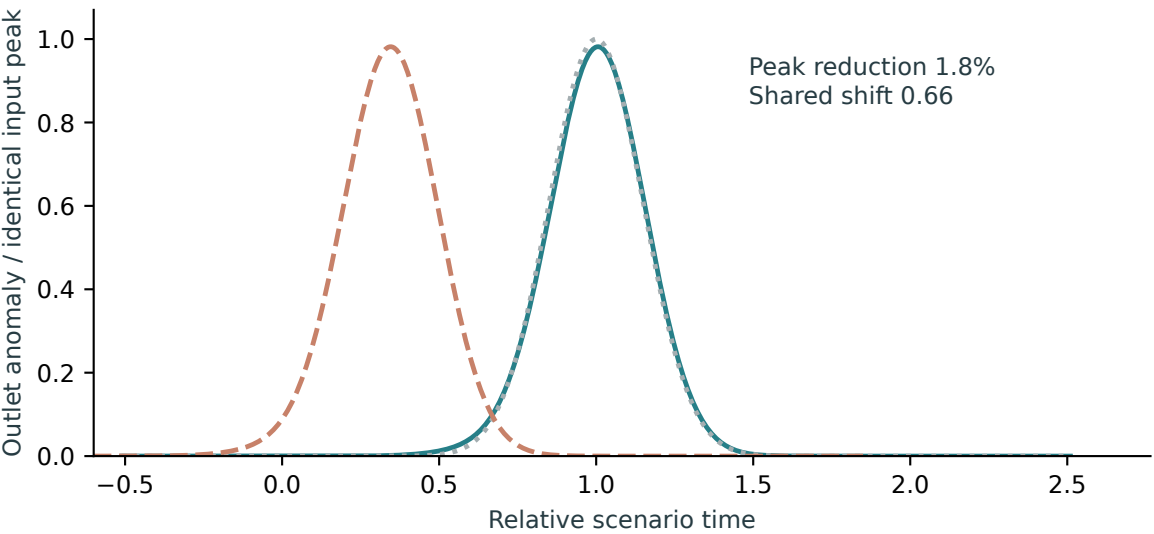
a Lower branch dispersion · lower common share



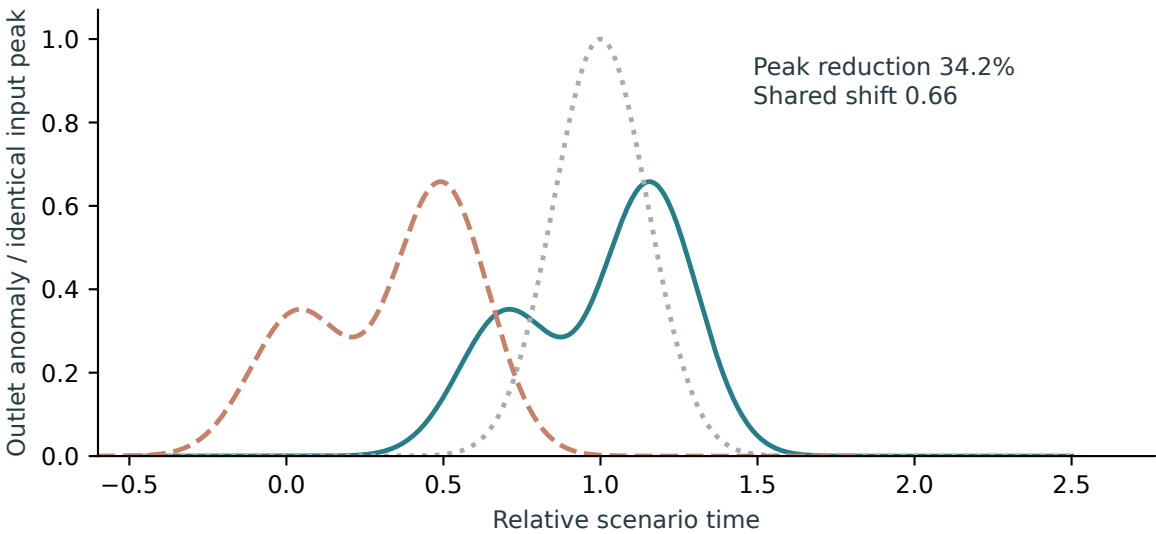
b Higher branch dispersion · lower common share



c Lower branch dispersion · higher common share



d Higher branch dispersion · higher common share



Identical source pulses, fixed area shares; actual mean delay = 1. Removing the trunk translates the curve without changing peak, width or mass. Mass and steady concentration preserved in all 59 connections. Relative time is not days; this routing scenario has no along-channel DOC removal.